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SYRIA · MONTHLY SECURITY OVERVIEW · JUNE 2026

A State Consolidating Its Institutions as the Ground Beneath Civilians Narrows

879 incidents across all 16 governorates, with declining volume concealing a hardening of violence: a reconstituting ISIS, the routinisation of Israeli military administration in the south, and a hazard burden that now kills more people than combat



June was a month of consolidation rather than escalation, in which a declining volume of recorded events concealed a hardening of the violence that remained. The transitional state was the single most active institutional presence in the data, generating a high tempo of arrests, cordon operations and checkpoints while associated with almost no fatalities. Yet across the eastern governorates that state activity coexisted with, rather than suppressed, a reconstituting insurgency, and in the south the highest concentration of incidents was the near-daily routine of Israeli military administration.

SARI Global assesses that the defining feature of the operating environment is a widening gap between institutional consolidation at the centre and a protection landscape that is diversifying rather than improving, in which hazards, explosive remnants of war and horizontal communal violence, not organised armed groups, now account for the majority of Syria's violent deaths.

Key Judgements

- 1 SARI Global recorded 879 incidents across all 16 governorates in June 2026. Incident volume declined week on week while fatalities held and then rose late in the month, an arc of consolidation in which fewer recorded events concealed a hardening of the violence that remained.
- 2 The Islamic State's operational footprint is substantially larger than any attribution field shows. The source data named the group once; cross-checking establishes at least four claimed attacks in June, including the 15 June suicide-belt assault on the Internal Security Command headquarters in Ar-Raqqa, its first use of belts since December. Total attack volume is down, but concentration on government targets and tactical sophistication are sharply up.
- 3 Israeli forces conducted their highest monthly operational total in nine months with zero recorded fatalities. A force running checkpoints, collecting identity data and detaining residents inside Syrian territory is administering territory, not prosecuting a campaign; the harm accrues through detention, demolition and access denial rather than casualties.
- 4 Hazards, not armed conflict, were the largest incident category and a leading cause of death: fires, road-traffic accidents, drownings and explosive remnants of war. This is the characteristic epidemiology of a post-conflict transition and is routinely under-weighted because it does not present as violence.
- 5 With the former regime's coercive apparatus gone, the dominant lethal dynamic is now horizontal: inter-familial, tribal and sectarian violence produced the largest single share of fatalities. Syria's transition risk is principally a rule-of-law and reconciliation problem, not a counter-insurgency one, and the accountability process itself is generating communal escalation.

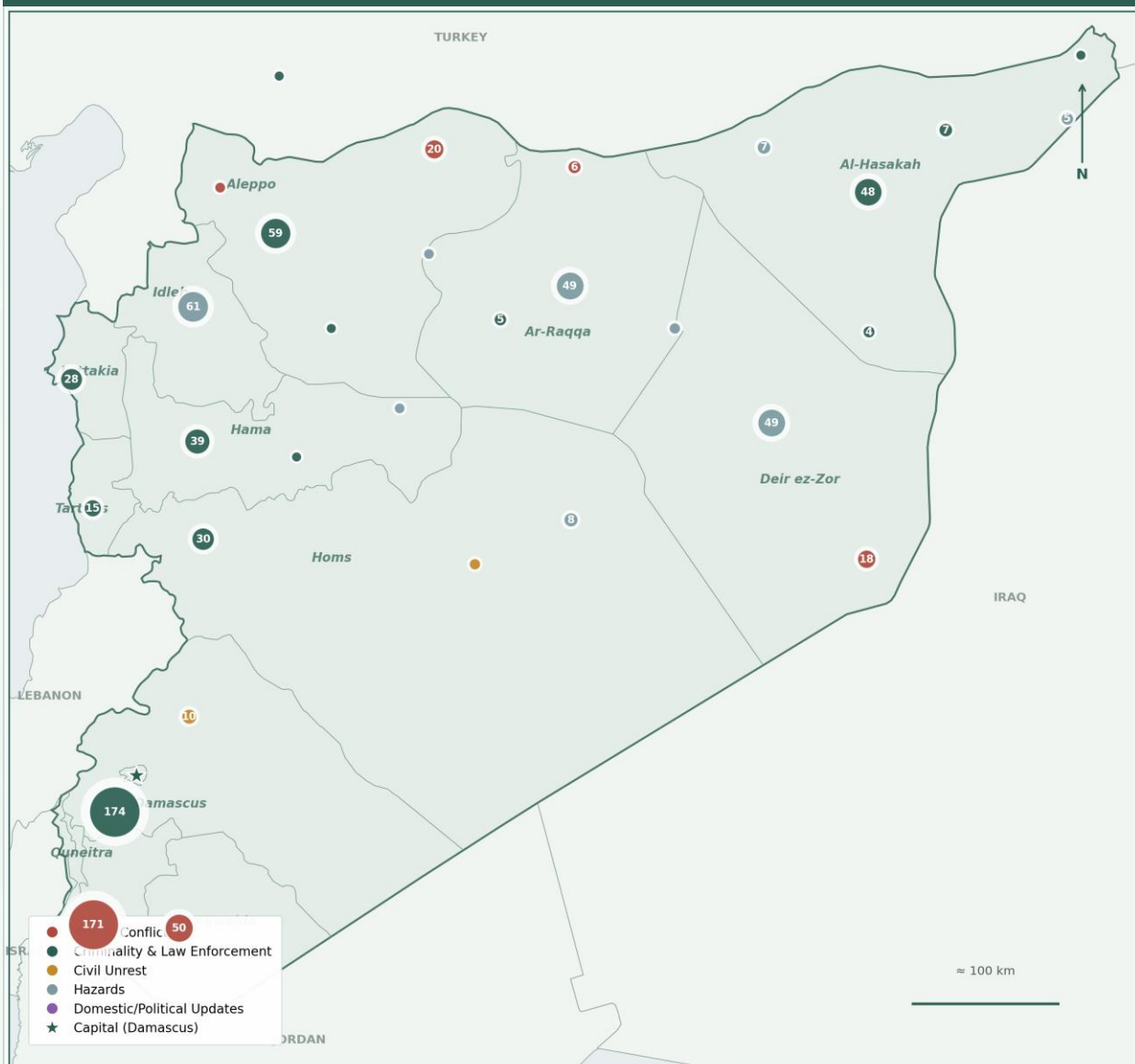
Monthly Overview

June opened at the month's highest tempo and gradually thinned, without ever becoming safer. The first week recorded the most incidents and the fourth the fewest, yet fatalities rose across the same span to peak late in the month. The arc is therefore one of consolidation rather than escalation, in which a declining volume of recorded events concealed a hardening of the violence that remained. Activity concentrated on 15, 8 and 1 June, and the geographic centre of gravity sat firmly in the south, with Dar'a and Quneitra together accounting for more than a quarter of everything recorded nationwide.

That southern concentration is almost entirely a function of Israeli military activity. Israeli forces conducted their highest total in nine months, spread across ground incursions into villages, mobile checkpoints, drone overflights, artillery fire and missile strikes, and not one produced a recorded fatality. The absence of deaths should not be mistaken for the absence of harm. Independent monitoring places Israeli positions well beyond the ceasefire line established by the 1974 Disengagement Agreement, with de facto control over roughly 235 square kilometres, and Human Rights Watch documented home seizures,

demolitions and the razing of agricultural land. What the data captures as a high-frequency, zero-fatality pattern is better understood as the routinisation of military administration over a Syrian population.

FIGURE 1 · SYRIA — NATIONWIDE INCIDENT DISTRIBUTION, JUNE 2026



879 geolocated incidents across all 16 governorates, clustered by proximity; marker size reflects incident count and colour the dominant category. The southern belt of Dar'a and Quneitra carries the highest density, driven by Israeli operations, while the Euphrates corridor and the northeast carry the insurgent signature.

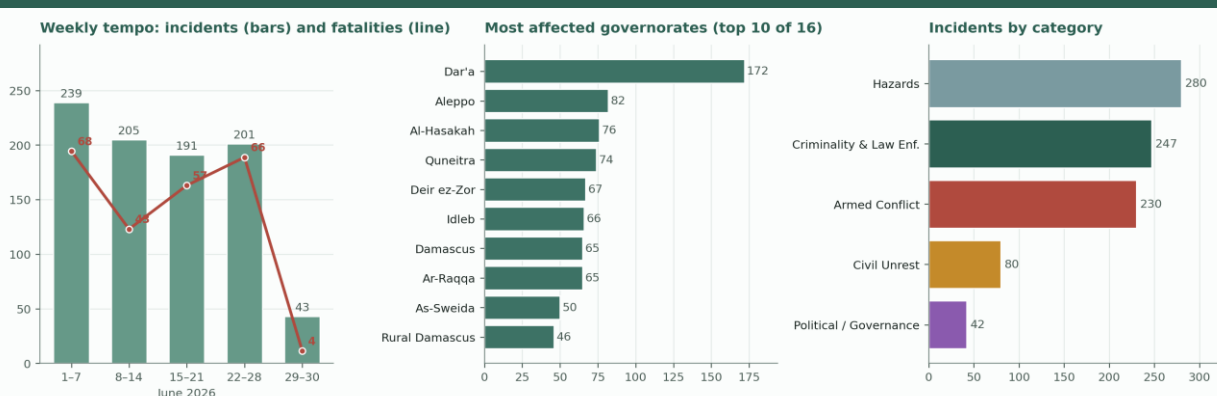
SOURCE SARI Global monitoring, June 2026 (n = 879 geolocated). Boundaries: Natural Earth 1:10m.

In the northeast and along the Euphrates the month's most consequential security development unfolded largely unattributed. On 15 June two Islamic State operatives wearing explosive belts assaulted the Internal Security Command headquarters in central Ar-Raqqa, the group's first use of suicide belts since December. On 16 June an improvised explosive device struck the vehicle of the head of the judicial section in Babila, south of Damascus, severing his leg. The group also attacked an Iraqi oil tanker on the Aleppo to Manbij road and killed two soldiers in the Manbij countryside on 20 June, publicly claiming all four. This is a group executing fewer operations than a year ago but choosing harder targets, against a security apparatus reported in Ar-Raqqa to be operating at roughly a fifth of its required strength.

Alongside these organised threats, the month's actual killing was overwhelmingly horizontal. Inter-familial disputes, tribal clashes and communal friction produced the largest single share of fatalities in the dataset. A dispute between two families in Manjila, Lattakia, on 25 June left five dead; armed clashes between local factions in Ar-Raha, As-Sweida, on 28 June killed four. With the former regime's coercive apparatus gone and a national security architecture still forming, the dominant lethal dynamic in Syria is now community against community, and increasingly majority against minority, rather than state against insurgent.

The transitional state itself was the single most active institutional presence in the data. Law-enforcement operations were the most frequent recorded event type nationwide, and the state security apparatus generated a high count of incidents while being associated with almost no deaths. This is a high-tempo, low-lethality posture of arrests, seizures, cordon operations and checkpoints that reflects genuine consolidation, including the integration of four SDF brigades into the national armed forces and the release of approximately 1,300 SDF-affiliated detainees. But high state activity is not the same as improving security. In Ar-Raqqa and Deir ez-Zor the operational tempo coexisted with, rather than suppressed, the insurgent signature.

FIGURE 2 · INCIDENT TEMPO AND STRUCTURE, JUNE 2026



Left: weekly incidents (bars) against confirmed fatalities (line), showing volume thinning while lethality holds. Centre: the ten most affected of the 16 governorates, led by Dar'a. Right: incident categories, with hazards the single largest strand ahead of criminality and armed conflict.

SOURCE SARI Global monitoring, June 2026 (n = 879).

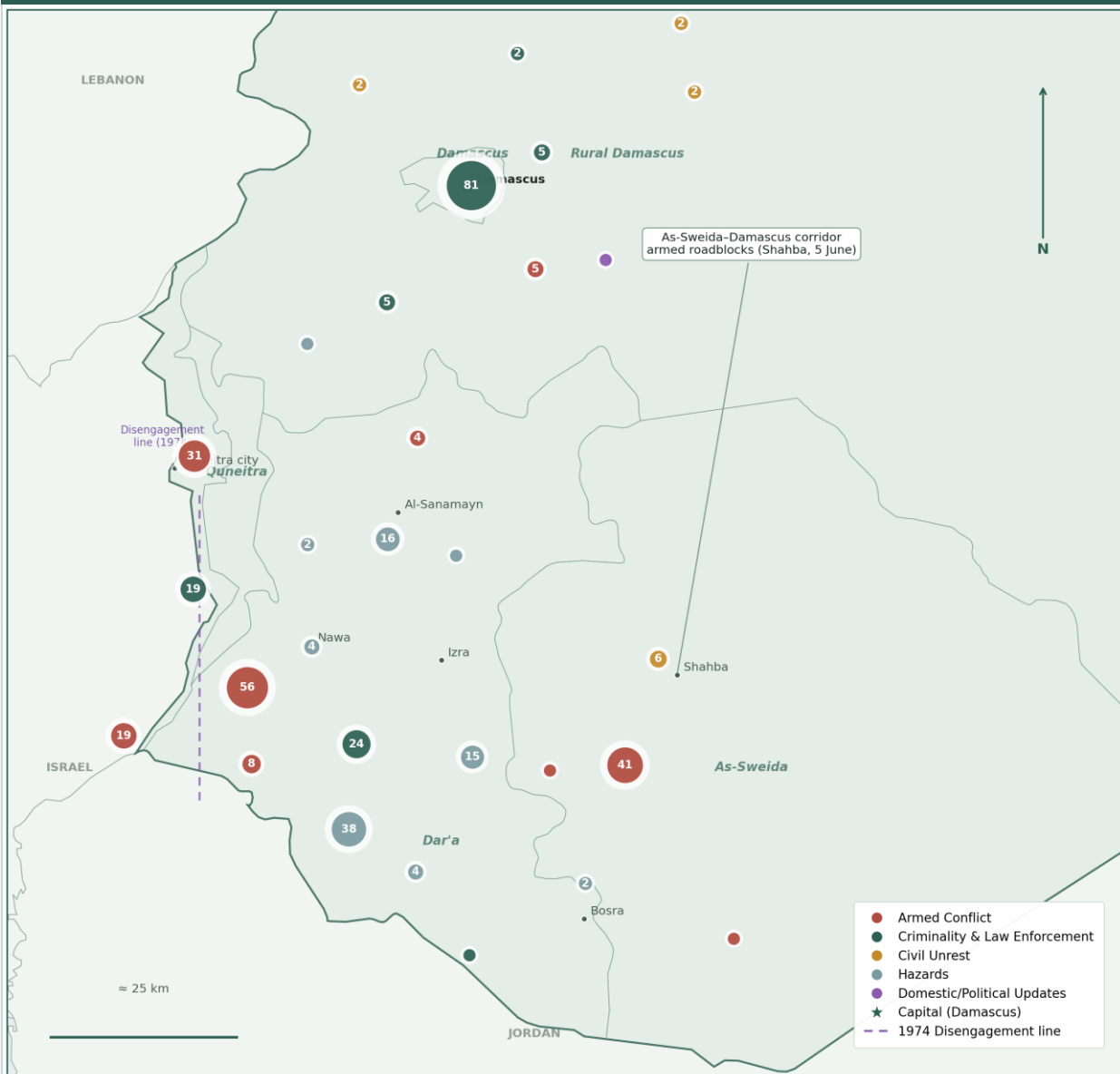
Geographic Overview

Dar'a and Quneitra — The Southern Occupation Zone

The southern governorates were the most incident-dense in the country. The overwhelming majority of activity is attributable to Israeli military operations, which took the form of ground incursions into villages such as Saida al-Hanout, Abu Madhara and Al-Asha, mobile checkpoints on civilian routes, drone overflights, artillery fire and, on eight occasions, missile strikes. The defining characteristic is low lethality and high friction: no fatalities were recorded from Israeli operations during the month, yet the cumulative effect on civilian life is severe, with agricultural land rendered inaccessible, movement corridors

interdicted, and residents subject to search and detention. Israeli leadership publicly confirmed during June that forces would remain in these areas indefinitely, and the Security Council renewed the UNDOF mandate on 25 June without constraining activity beyond the line.

FIGURE 3 · SOUTHERN SYRIA — DAR'A, QUNEITRA AND AS-SWEIDA, JUNE 2026



The southern belt combines the highest incident density in the country, driven by Israeli operations around the 1974 Disengagement line, with the armed roadblocks that periodically close the As-Sweida–Damascus corridor. Risk here is defined by detention, access denial and unannounced closure rather than by fatalities.

SOURCE SARI Global monitoring, June 2026. Boundaries: Natural Earth 1:10m; disengagement line indicative.

Operational implications. Movement in Quneitra and western Dar'a requires current, route-specific assessment and should assume the possibility of checkpoint interception, identity checks and detention. Agricultural and rural sites near Israeli installations carry demolition and access-denial risk. Do not model this environment on fatality data; the operative risks are detention, property destruction and access denial.

Deir ez-Zor, Ar-Raqqa and Al-Hasakah — The Insurgent Corridor

The eastern governorates carry the country's most serious organised armed threat. Ar-Raqqa was the site of the month's most significant single attack, the 15 June suicide-belt assault on the Internal Security Command headquarters. Al-Hasakah saw an ambush on a Ministry of Defence transport bus between Tel Tamer and Ras al-Ain that wounded ten personnel on 18 June, an ambush on the Qamishli road that killed two security personnel on 25 June, and an explosive device detonated in a civilian vehicle in Qamishli city. Deir ez-Zor sustained the classic pattern of a reconstituting insurgency: an IED on a public street in Al-Bukamal, a grenade thrown at a private residence in Al-Kharita, an explosive device at a military headquarters in Abu Kamal on 27 June, an RPG attack on an Internal Security checkpoint at the Al-Basirah bridge on 29 June, and a sequence of unattributed assassinations in outlying villages. Almost none of this activity carries an actor label in the source data; the signature, however, is unmistakable.

Operational implications. Treat the Deir ez-Zor, Ar-Raqqa and Al-Hasakah corridor as an active insurgency environment irrespective of the low volume of formally attributed attacks. Reintroduce explosive ordnance coordination, convoy hardening and threat-warning protocols. Assume the targeting of security infrastructure, checkpoints and military transport, and avoid co-location with those assets.

Aleppo and Idleb — The New Front

Aleppo has emerged, in the assessment of independent conflict monitors, as a new operational front for the Islamic State after being largely absent in earlier periods. The month saw an attack on an Iraqi oil tanker on the Aleppo to Manbij road, an explosive device in a security vehicle in Al-Bab, an IED against a military transport bus on the Maskanah highway, the killing of two soldiers in the Manbij countryside on 20 June, and a motorcycle-borne assassination of a defence official in As-Safira on 28 June. Beyond the insurgent picture, Aleppo and Idleb carried a heavy load of fires, road-traffic accidents and explosive remnants of war, including UXO detonations in Al-Bab and Azaz that injured civilians. The north combined an emerging insurgent front with the country's characteristic hazard burden, producing a compound risk environment along the M4 and Manbij corridors.

Operational implications. The eastward corridors of Aleppo governorate, particularly the Manbij and Maskanah axes, should be reclassified as elevated-threat for IED and ambush risk. Oil and commercial transport on these routes has been directly targeted. Combine explosive ordnance risk education with journey management for all movement in the governorate.

As-Sweida — Contested Reintegration

The defining feature of As-Sweida is not incident volume but character: armed factions maintained roadblocks on the main highway toward Damascus, including near Shahba city on 5 June, and inter-factional clashes continued, with heavy fighting between two local factions in Ar-Raha on 28 June killing four. This is the unresolved sediment of the July 2025 crisis, in which fighting between Druze-led and Bedouin armed groups, compounded by government intervention and Israeli airstrikes, produced mass displacement and documented unlawful killings on all sides. The US-mediated ceasefire of 16 July 2025 returned governance and security to Druze-led structures, restoring the governorate's informal autonomy

without provisions for civilian protection, aid access or accountability. At month end As-Sweida remained outside effective central control, with a fragmented armed landscape and no political framework for reintegration.

Operational implications. The As-Sweida to Damascus corridor is subject to armed-actor roadblocks that can close without warning. Verify route status before every movement and maintain contingency for extended closure. Engagement in the governorate requires acceptance negotiated with local armed structures rather than reliance on central government authorisation.

Damascus and Rural Damascus — The Political Centre

The capital and its rural belt were dominated by law-enforcement operations, judicial proceedings and protest activity. The month's most significant security event was the 16 June improvised explosive device that struck the vehicle of the head of the judicial section in Babila, severing his leg, an attack claimed by the Islamic State and directed against the machinery of transitional justice. Protest activity was persistent and politically charged: a civilian sit-in outside the Parliament building on 6 June demanded equal employment opportunity and anti-corruption measures, and across the first half of the month protests demanding accountability for crimes committed under the former government erupted in several cities, with some escalating into mob violence against minorities and individuals associated with the previous administration.

Operational implications. Personnel associated with judicial, transitional justice or government-adjacent functions face a demonstrated targeted-attack risk in the Damascus periphery. Vary routines and vehicle profiles. Plan for sudden protest-driven mobility restriction in the capital, and note the risk of accountability protests escalating into communal violence.

Homs, Hama, Latakia and Tartous — The Central and Coastal Belt

The central and coastal governorates recorded comparatively low volume but produced some of the month's most lethal individual events. A violent dispute between two families in the village of Manjila, Latakia, on 25 June left five dead. Sectarian friction in Homs produced a fatal armed assault on a shop owner on 8 June and the killing of an elderly shepherd in the eastern desert on 11 June, the latter in the Badiya corridor that remains a historic Islamic State operating area. The dominant recorded activity, however, was hazard-driven: fires, road-traffic accidents and structural failures, alongside a continuing tempo of state security operations including cordon and search raids around Salhab in Hama.

Operational implications. The eastern Homs desert corridor warrants continued monitoring as a residual Islamic State operating area. Elsewhere in the belt, the dominant risks to personnel are road safety, fire and communal disputes rather than organised armed violence.

Trend Analysis

Trend 01 — The Islamic State: Attribution Collapse, Capability Intact

The most consequential finding of the month is that the Islamic State's operational footprint in Syria is substantially larger than any actor-attribution field will show. The source data named the group in a single record. Cross-checking against open-source reporting establishes that the group publicly claimed at least four distinct attacks in June, every one of which appears in the dataset under generic labels such as unknown or non-state armed actors, and a further three incidents match the group's tradecraft and heartland geography without carrying a public claim. Beyond these seven, the eastern corridor produced a dense cluster of unattributed insurgent-signature attacks. Across the dataset, a large body of incidents carrying scores of fatalities remains unattributed. That is where this campaign lives.

The strategic reading requires reconciling two apparently contradictory measurements. Independent conflict monitoring records attacks on government forces rising sharply through the first half of 2026 against the whole of 2025, concentrated in Deir ez-Zor, Ar-Raqqa and, newly, Aleppo. Separately, other analysis assessed that total operations fell through the spring following the withdrawal of United States forces. Both are correct: total attack volume is down, while concentration onto government targets and tactical sophistication are sharply up. The 15 June Ar-Raqqa operation supports that thesis, employing suicide belts for the first time since December against a fortified facility in a provincial capital. The enabling conditions are structural: Ar-Raqqa's police force is reported at roughly a fifth of required strength after the government's rapid expansion into former SDF territory stretched a security apparatus that lacked the personnel to hold it. On current indicators the group is reconstituting rather than resurging.

Operational implications. Do not calibrate posture in the northeast to the volume of formally attributed attacks. Treat the Deir ez-Zor, Ar-Raqqa, Al-Hasakah and eastern Aleppo corridor as an active insurgency environment. Reinstate explosive ordnance risk education, convoy hardening and route survey. Avoid co-location with security-force assets, checkpoints and military transport. Staff in transitional justice or judicial support functions face a specific, claimed targeting risk.

Trend 02 — Israeli Operations as Administration, Not Campaign

Israeli Armed Forces were associated with the highest monthly incident count in nine months and zero recorded fatalities. That combination is the analytical signal. The composition is telling: armed assaults and altercations, ground incursions, mobile checkpoints, drone overflights, artillery fire, eight missile strikes, and a notable number of events coded as law-enforcement operations conducted inside Syrian territory. A military force conducting law enforcement, running checkpoints, collecting identity data and detaining residents is not prosecuting a campaign; it is administering territory. Independent monitoring places Israeli positions beyond the 1974 ceasefire line with de facto control over approximately 235 square kilometres, and Human Rights Watch documented home seizures and demolitions, the razing of forest and agricultural land, and the transfer of Syrian detainees into Israel. The likely path is entrenchment,

with the humanitarian consequences accruing quietly through access denial rather than visibly through casualty figures.

Operational implications. Risk assessment for the south must be built on detention, property destruction and access denial rather than on fatality data, which will systematically understate exposure. Assume checkpoint interception and identity verification on all movement in Quneitra and western Dar'a. Avoid siting activities or assets near Israeli installations. Programme design for agricultural or livelihoods support in the belt should assume long-term access constraint.

Trend 03 — The Hazard Burden: Syria's Quiet Mass-Casualty Story

The single largest category of recorded incidents in June was not armed conflict but hazards. Fires, road-traffic accidents, drownings and explosive remnants of war together produced a fatality toll exceeding that of armed conflict. This is the characteristic epidemiology of a post-conflict transition, and it is routinely under-weighted in security reporting because it does not present as violence. Fifteen years of war degraded road infrastructure, electrical systems, building stock and water management simultaneously, while the institutions that would normally regulate them were hollowed out. Mass return compounds the exposure: displaced families re-entering damaged housing, driving degraded highways and swimming in unregulated waterways. The 3 June head-on collision on the Athriya to Ar-Raqqa highway killed six in a single event, a figure exceeded by no armed attack in the dataset. The picture is likely to deteriorate through the summer, as fire and drowning risk peak and returnee volumes rise against a humanitarian appeal funded at roughly a fifth of requirement.

Operational implications. Weight protection and assistance programming toward hazard exposure rather than conflict exposure, which is where the mortality actually sits. Duty of care should prioritise road safety, journey management and fire precautions, statistically the largest threats to personnel in Syria this month. Support to civil defence capacity is a high-return intervention.

Trend 04 — Explosive Remnants of War as the Legacy Killer

Explosive remnants of war detonated 27 times in June, killing at least 18 people, concentrated in Deir ez-Zor, Aleppo, Dar'a and Ar-Raqqa, precisely the corridors into which displaced families are returning. These are not conflict casualties in any conventional sense; they are the delayed detonation of a war that formally ended eighteen months ago. The scale of contamination is exceptional even by post-conflict standards, with the mine-action sector estimating that more than two thousand people had been killed or injured by explosives by early 2026 and considering that an underestimate. The mechanism driving casualties is economic rather than accidental: returnees re-enter contaminated agricultural land because it is their livelihood, and the desperate scavenge scrap metal from ordnance. Clearance capacity is constrained principally by funding, with one estimate putting full remediation at 25 to 40 years at current resourcing.

Operational implications. Explosive ordnance risk education must be integrated into every returns, livelihoods and agricultural programme in the affected corridors, not treated as a specialist mine-action

activity. No off-road movement in former frontline areas without clearance confirmation. Field staff require UXO identification and reporting training as a baseline duty-of-care measure.

Trend 05 — Horizontal Violence: The Dominant Lethal Dynamic

With the former regime's coercive apparatus dismantled and a national security architecture still forming, the principal driver of violent death in Syria is now community against community. Incidents centred on civilians as the primary actor account for the largest fatality share of any actor category. Tribal clashes, inter-familial disputes and sectarian friction, not organised armed groups, produced the month's deadliest individual incidents: a dispute between two families in Manjila killed five; armed clashes between factions in Ar-Raha killed four; inter-familial clashes in the Zakyeh neighbourhood of Rural Damascus killed three. Disputes over land, water, honour and communal boundary are resolving through firearms because the mechanisms that would otherwise resolve them are absent or distrusted. The analytical significance is that Syria's transition risk is not principally a counter-insurgency problem; it is a rule-of-law and reconciliation problem, and it is worsened by the accountability process itself, as justice protests escalate into mob violence against minorities.

Operational implications. Conflict-sensitivity analysis and do-no-harm review should be mandatory for programming in mixed communities, particularly in Homs, Lattakia, Hama and rural Damascus. Beneficiary selection and hiring practices carry heightened escalation risk where communal grievance is live. Monitor accountability protests as a potential trigger for communal violence rather than as routine civil unrest.

Trend 06 — As-Sweida and the Unfinished Question of Reintegration

As-Sweida's material fact this month is the persistence of armed roadblocks on the highway toward Damascus and continuing inter-factional violence, the direct sediment of the July 2025 crisis. The 16 July 2025 ceasefire returned governance and security to Druze-led structures, restoring the governorate's informal autonomy but omitting any provision for civilian protection, aid access or accountability, and that omission is the operative problem. The governorate now functions with parallel authority, a fragmented armed landscape and contested leadership, sitting outside effective central control while remaining formally part of the Syrian state. Much depends on whether Damascus offers a political framework for reintegration that the Druze leadership can accept; none was in prospect during the reporting period, and the government appears content to leave the question unresolved while the Israeli presence to the west provides an alternative patron that further reduces the incentive to negotiate.

Operational implications. Access to As-Sweida cannot be secured through central government authorisation alone and requires acceptance negotiated with local armed structures. The Damascus corridor is subject to unannounced closure; verify status before each movement and maintain contingency for extended interruption. Treat the governorate as a distinct operating environment with its own actor mapping.

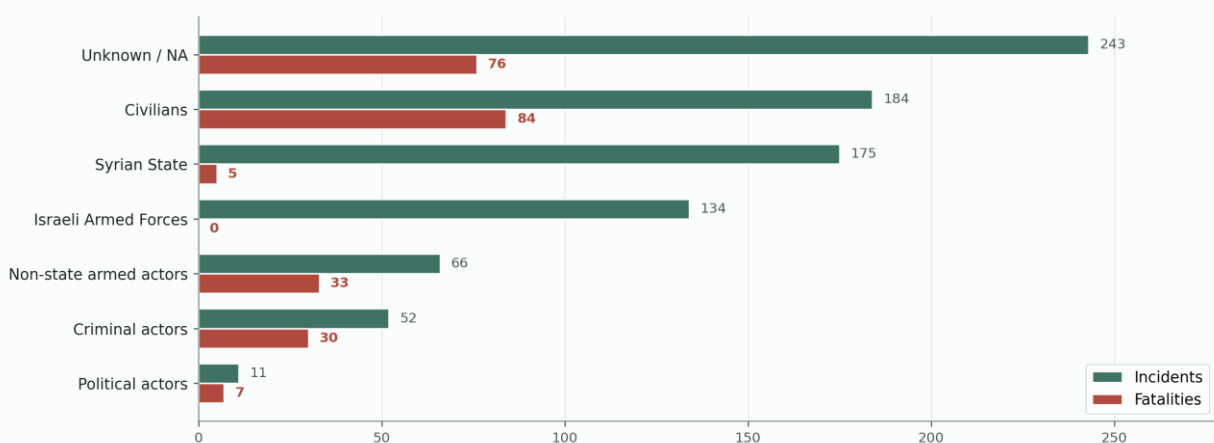
Trend 07 — The Transitional State: High Tempo, Low Lethality, Thin Coverage

The Syrian state security apparatus generated a high count of recorded incidents in June while associated with almost no deaths, and law-enforcement operations were the single most frequent event type

nationwide. This is a posture of arrests, cordon and search operations, checkpoints and judicial enforcement, and it represents genuine institutional consolidation, including the integration of four SDF brigades onto the national payroll, the release of approximately 1,300 SDF-affiliated detainees, and a three-month counter-terrorism campaign that produced 235 arrests. It also marks a genuine and largely positive departure from the coercive model of the former regime. But that softness carries its own hazard: to hold newly acquired territory the apparatus recruited rapidly, and time pressure makes it difficult to apply the vetting and training a professional force requires. Volume of activity is not coverage. The same rapid expansion into former SDF territory that produced these consolidation metrics stretched the apparatus beyond its trained personnel base, and it is precisely in the resulting gaps that the Islamic State has reconstituted.

Operational implications. Anchor risk assessment in the attributed-lethality picture and in the unattributed insurgent signature, not in the volume of state security activity. Do not treat state presence in the rural east as equivalent to security provision. Maintain clear operational separation from state security forces to protect perceived neutrality, particularly in the northeast where those forces are the declared target of insurgent attack.

FIGURE 4 · ATTRIBUTION — INCIDENTS AGAINST FATALITIES BY PRIMARY ACTOR, JUNE 2026



Israeli forces and the Syrian state generate high incident counts with almost no associated fatalities, while civilians (the coding for horizontal, community-level violence) and unattributed actors carry the bulk of the deaths. The attribution gap is the analytical story: the lethal insurgent campaign in the east sits largely inside the unattributed total.

SOURCE SARI Global monitoring, June 2026. Actor attribution reconciled against open-source reporting where public claims exist.

Humanitarian Outlook

The humanitarian picture at month end is one of acute and worsening resource constraint colliding with a protection environment that is diversifying rather than improving. The 2026 humanitarian appeal, requiring 2.92 billion dollars to support 8.6 million people, stood at roughly 20 percent funded, and the World Food Programme has halved emergency food assistance. Returns continue to accelerate, with more

than 390,000 people having crossed from Lebanon since early March, placing mounting pressure on services that were already degraded.

The protection risks facing returning populations are precisely those documented in this month's data. Explosive remnants of war detonate in the agricultural land and damaged housing to which families return. Fires, road-traffic accidents and drownings kill more people than combat. Euphrates flooding at the end of May affected over 17,600 people and damaged farmland and critical infrastructure, with consequences visible in Ar-Raqqa through June. Food insecurity, halved rations and the coping behaviours they produce feed directly into the hazard casualty figures.

Access constraints are geographically specific and structurally distinct. In the south, Israeli military administration denies access to agricultural land and interdicts movement corridors without producing casualties. In As-Sweida, armed roadblocks close the Damascus highway at the discretion of local factions. In the eastern governorates, a reconstituting insurgency targets exactly the security infrastructure that humanitarian convoys travel alongside, making proximity to state forces a liability rather than a protection. The gap between need and response capacity is widening in all three directions at once, and national staff, who carry the majority of field exposure, bear the consequence.

Risk Assessment Matrix

THREAT	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
Insurgent attack (ISIS, northeast and eastern Aleppo)	HIGH	CRITICAL	Treat as active insurgency despite low attribution. EOD coordination, convoy hardening, route survey, no co-location with security assets.
Explosive remnants of war	HIGH	SEVERE	Mandatory EORE in all returns and livelihoods programming; no off-road movement without clearance; staff UXO identification training.
Road traffic and fire	HIGH	SEVERE	Journey management, defensive driving, daylight-only movement on degraded highways, fire precautions at all fixed sites.
Israeli military operations (south)	HIGH	MODERATE	Assess on detention and access-denial risk, not casualties. Route-specific clearance; avoid siting near Israeli installations.
Horizontal and communal violence	HIGH	SEVERE	Conflict-sensitivity and do-no-harm review; careful beneficiary selection and hiring; monitor accountability protests as escalation triggers.
Armed roadblocks and access denial (As-Sweida)	HIGH	MODERATE	Negotiate acceptance with local armed structures; verify route before every movement; contingency stock for extended closure.
Targeted assassination (judicial / defence officials)	MEDIUM	SEVERE	Vary routines and vehicle profiles for at-risk staff; low-profile posture; review association with transitional justice functions.

Communal escalation from transitional justice	MEDIUM	SEVERE	Monitor protest activity; avoid programming visibility during accountability flashpoints; protect minority staff.
Civil unrest and protest	HIGH	LOW	Dynamic routing around protest sites; shelter-in-place readiness in Damascus and coastal cities.
Humanitarian funding collapse	HIGH	CRITICAL	Prioritise life-saving modalities; plan for reduced caseload coverage; anticipate coping-behaviour-driven hazard casualties.

Strategic Recommendations

1 Re-baseline the northeast on insurgency, not on attribution counts.

The Islamic State claimed four attacks in June that the incident record labels unknown. Rebuild the security framework for Deir ez-Zor, Ar-Raqqa, Al-Hasakah and eastern Aleppo around an active-insurgency assumption. Reinstate explosive ordnance coordination, convoy hardening, route survey and threat-warning protocols, and treat security-force assets, checkpoints and military transport as targets to be avoided rather than escorts to be sought.

2 Reweight duty of care toward hazards, which are killing more people than combat.

Fires, road traffic, drowning and explosive remnants produced the largest share of the month's confirmed deaths. Journey management, defensive-driving standards, daylight-only movement on degraded highways and fire precautions at fixed sites are, statistically, the highest-return staff-safety measures available in Syria. Support to civil defence capacity is a proportionate programmatic response.

3 Integrate explosive ordnance risk education into every returns and livelihoods programme.

Contamination is concentrated in exactly the corridors receiving returnees. Treat EORE as a core component of agricultural, shelter and livelihoods activity rather than a specialist mine-action function, prohibit off-road movement in former frontline areas without clearance confirmation, and train all field staff in identification and reporting.

4 Assess southern Syria on detention and access denial, not on casualty data.

Israeli forces conducted their highest operational total in nine months without a recorded fatality while seizing homes, demolishing buildings, razing agricultural land and detaining residents. Any risk model built on fatality figures will systematically understate exposure in Quneitra and western Dar'a. Assume checkpoint interception, avoid siting assets near Israeli installations, and design livelihoods programming for long-term access constraint.

5 Negotiate As-Sweida access with local armed structures, not through Damascus.

The governorate operates under informal autonomy with no agreed provisions on aid access or civilian protection. Central authorisation will not open the Damascus corridor, which local factions close at will. Build a distinct actor map for the governorate, verify route status before every movement, and hold contingency stock for extended closure.

6 Make conflict-sensitivity review mandatory in mixed communities.

Inter-familial, tribal and sectarian violence is the largest single driver of violent death in the country. Beneficiary selection, hiring and visible programme presence all carry escalation risk where communal grievance is live. Apply do-no-harm review in Homs, Lattakia, Hama and rural Damascus, and treat accountability protests as a potential trigger for communal violence rather than as routine unrest.

7 Protect staff associated with judicial and transitional justice functions.

The Islamic State claimed an IED attack that severed the leg of a judicial official in Babila, and a defence official was assassinated in As-Safira. Personnel connected to accountability, judicial support or government-adjacent functions require varied routines, low-profile movement and a reassessment of visible institutional association.

8 Plan for a funding shortfall that will manifest as hazard casualties.

With the appeal at roughly a fifth of requirement and rations halved, coping behaviours will intensify: scavenging in contaminated ground, informal construction, unregulated travel. These are the direct upstream causes of the month's largest fatality category. Prioritise life-saving modalities, model reduced caseload coverage explicitly, and pair any assistance reduction with intensified risk education.



SARI Global

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